TOPIC 2 · MICROSOFT COPILOT FOR EXCEL
LAB 6 THEME · REPORTING SKILL

# Lab 6 — Create, Use and Improve the HR Service Reporting Skill

| | |
|---|---|
| **Maps to** | LO2: plan a controlled transition using Personalisation, .Rules and reusable Skills. |
| **Duration** | 30 minutes |
| **Tools** | Excel and PowerPoint Copilot · Microsoft 365 Copilot web · OneDrive |
| **Mock data** | data/Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx |
| **Lab files** | data/templates/hr-case-reporting/SKILL.md (Reviewed reporting Skill fallback); data/templates/Transition_Plan.csv (LO2 controlled transition checkpoint) |
| **Course** | Enhance Work Productivity with Microsoft 365 Copilot (TGS-2024043856) · v9.5 |
| **Prompts** | https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2024043856-Enhance-Work-Productivity-with-Microsoft-365-Copilot/prompts/#lab-6 |

## Goal

Reuse the Skill-authoring and installation method from Lab 5 to create hr-case-reporting. Apply it in Excel and PowerPoint, test missing inputs and a controlled rerun, then refine v2 using actual evidence. The supplied reviewed template supports rejoining; it is not proof of native execution.

## What You Will Do

Reuse the Skill-authoring and installation method from Lab 5 to create hr-case-reporting. Apply it in Excel and PowerPoint, test missing inputs and a controlled rerun, then refine v2 using actual evidence. The supplied reviewed template supports rejoining; it is not proof of native execution.

## What You Will Build

Lumina_Skill_Report.xlsx with HR_Case_Summary and Assignment_Proposals, Lumina_Skill_Update.pptx, SKILL.md v2 and a before/after improvement log.

## Prerequisites

- Labs 1–2 verified brief and four-slide update; Lab 5 Skill-authoring method.

**Data note**

Lumina Living Pte Ltd and all of its employees, HR cases and HR policies are fictional. Use the verified 120-case baseline and fixed reporting date 30 September 2026. Current case owners are evidence; proposals are not approved. The HR agent answers from approved knowledge only and never approves requests, sends messages or reveals another employee's data.

## Steps

**Step 1.** Use Microsoft 365 Copilot on the web to draft hr-case-reporting/SKILL.md from the complete specification below. Review it against data/templates/hr-case-reporting/SKILL.md, save the complete file as v1 in your Lumina-HR-v9 output folder, then install it using the same Excel app-created custom Skills folder and Refresh route practised in Lab5. If a native Skill menu is missing, use the full reviewed file as pasted instructions, remove @mention and label the route manual.

**PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt**

```
MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT WEB:
Write complete hr-case-reporting SKILL.md with YAML name/description. Require actual
tblHRCases or a verified Word snapshot, report date and filter scope. Respect visible .Rules.
Define backlog, overdue and Closed-only on-time rate. Preserve IDs/statuses/current owners;
keep assignment proposals separate and approvals UNKNOWN. Create a verified Excel summary and
improve a supplied four- or eight-slide PowerPoint report from selected evidence. Ask for
missing inputs and before replacing only named outputs; rerun without duplicates or source
changes. Keep the existing design and source/date notes. Never send email or approve
assignments. Return the entire file.
```

**Step 2.** Copy the Lab 6 reviewed SKILL.md to your output folder and retain v1. Open this lab's clean workbook or your Lab 1 cleaned workbook. Save as Lumina_Skill_Report.xlsx. Read HR_Officers: primary category and available hours are synthetic planning inputs, not approvals. Check that your skill is enabled in Excel.

**Step 3.** Invoke the skill in Plan or Chat only, review its proposed output boundaries, then allow editing. Inspect the resulting formulas and charts. Summary counts must reconcile to Control, and the source table must remain 120 unique records.

**PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt**

```
EXCEL - PLAN:
@hr-case-reporting Build HR_Case_Summary for tblHRCases at 2026-09-30 with all filters All.
Include total, closed, cancelled, backlog, overdue, on-time closed rate and recorded cost;
show formulas and source scope. Plan first. Preserve source records.

EXCEL - ALLOW EDITING:
Apply that reviewed summary plan. Add Assignment_Proposals for unassigned backlog only. Use
tblHROfficers primary category and available hours as planning inputs; show category/capacity
checks, current owner and proposed owner separately. Leave manager decision UNKNOWN. Do not
change Assigned_To.
```

**Step 4.** Check the unassigned backlog count against Control. An HR officer with the same category may still lack usable capacity: use available hours minus known proposed hours, flag conflicts, and do not convert a suggestion into confirmed assignment. Export your verified summary into the Word snapshot template, preserving measures and date.

**PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt**

```
EXCEL - CHAT ONLY:
@hr-case-reporting Review Assignment_Proposals against tblHRCases and tblHROfficers. Check
each suggested owner has the matching HR-case request type, capacity limitations are visible
and original Assigned_To values are unchanged. Leave manager approval UNKNOWN; do not assign
or schedule an HR officer.
```

**Step 5.** In PowerPoint select the reviewed Word snapshot and open the four-slide update from Lab2 or data/checkpoints/Lumina_Initial_Update_Checkpoint.pptx. Use Copilot > + > Choose skills > Manage skills > Add skill to upload the reviewed hr-case-reporting file, or use the app's own supported Skills folder. Verify it in PowerPoint separately from Excel. If missing, paste the complete reviewed Skill plus snapshot as manual instructions and remove @mention. Apply the following refinement after review.

**PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt**

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
@hr-case-reporting Improve this existing four-slide Lumina update from the selected verified
Word snapshot. Preserve slide count, all values and source/date/scope notes; use clear claim
headlines and the existing design. Keep assignment suggestions explicitly proposed and do not
assume access to Excel chat.
```

**Step 6.** Create a new EMPTY workbook with no table, open a fresh Copilot chat and run a missing-input test for a different reporting period with no source selected. A proper skill asks for source/date/scope rather than inventing metrics. If it guesses, record the failure and revise the skill's input guard. Return to Lumina_Skill_Report.xlsx and Save As Lumina_Skill_Rerun_Test.xlsx. Run the second summary request in this copy of the report workbook, not in the empty workbook; only named outputs may be replaced after review, with no duplicated source or output sheets. Compare a before/after copy of HR_Cases sorted by Case_ID for status, owner, dates and cost; every original source value must match.

**PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt**

```
EXCEL - CHAT ONLY:
@hr-case-reporting Prepare my next HR service report. I need a DIFFERENT reporting period from
the course example and have not supplied any source, date or scope. This empty workbook
contains no HR cases. Tell me what you need; do not invent data.

EXCEL - PLAN:
@hr-case-reporting Rebuild the existing HR_Case_Summary for the same table, date and scope.
Describe what will be replaced, ask before replacement and keep source/unrelated sheets. Do
not duplicate outputs.
```

**Step 7.** In a plain text editor improve SKILL.md: require an input guard, category/capacity evidence, source provenance per claim and a clear rerun rule. Retain YAML name hr-case-reporting and add a body version note v2. Re-upload/Refresh in BOTH Excel and PowerPoint. Record actual before/after changes, or already present - retained for safeguards that your v1 already contains. Do not fabricate differences. Rerun the smoke tests and compare values. If using the manual route, replace the pasted instructions in both apps.

**PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt**

```
MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT WEB:
Improve this supplied hr-case-reporting skill to v2 using only my actual smoke-test and rerun
findings pasted here. Add explicit missing-input and no-duplicate-output guards. Keep Excel
source and current owners protected. Return the complete revised SKILL.md and a short
before/after change log; do not fabricate test evidence.
```

**Step 8.** Complete Transition_Plan.csv for Baseline, Pilot, Staff readiness and Controlled rollout. Include a .Rules or Skill rerun test, success measure and last-passing rollback record.

## Sample Prompts

Use the app labelled for each prompt (or adapt it). Name the table and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. Use the linked prompts web page for one-click Copy buttons.

**Copy-ready prompts:** https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2024043856-Enhance-Work-Productivity-with-Microsoft-365-Copilot/prompts/#lab-6

| # | Purpose | Prompt |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Run Skill | Apply @hr-case-reporting to the verified Lumina snapshot; include total 120, backlog 60, overdue 50, source, scope and limitations. |
| 2 | Rerun | Change one filter only, rerun the Skill and reconcile the new result to the unchanged source table. |

## Test It

| Check | Expected result |
|---|---|
| Source preserved | 120 unique cases; current owner/status unchanged. |
| Skill outputs | Backlog 60; overdue 50; on-time closed 30/48; cost S$35,827.50. |
| Improvement evidence | Input guard and rerun tested; v1/v2 retained; PowerPoint four-slide output accurate. |
| LO2 checkpoint | Four transition stages have owners, evidence, success measures and rollback triggers. |

## Checkpoint

If you fell behind, use data/checkpoints/Lumina_Verified_Checkpoint.xlsx and data/checkpoints/Lumina_Verified_Snapshot.docx. Record checkpoint used in Prompt_Log; then perform this lab, rather than claiming the checkpoint as your output.

## Troubleshooting

| If this happens | Fix |
|---|---|
| Copilot cannot find the source | Use the app file picker to select the actual OneDrive file. A typed local path or a different app chat is not shared context. If needed copy only the verified snapshot into the current app. |
| A total disagrees with Control | Clear dashboard filters to All, check table extent and duplicate IDs, recalculate, then compare definitions and reporting date. Reconcile before continuing. |
| The named feature is missing | Confirm the correct assigned account, English display language and app version. Use the stated manual practice route; record feature unavailable. This is not evidence that a native skill ran. |

## Challenge

Repeat the task for one different department and explain how the filter scope changes the result. Keep the original verified output.

## Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?